

RIATAVINS INDEPENDENCE

A Forgotten Realms Adventure set in the Lands of Intrigue, Year DR1370, Month of Uktar. Exact location of adventure takes place in the city of Riatavin, a city that has just recently become a new member of Tethyr, and a part of the Golden Marches in the county of Valashar.

Riatavin is ruled by the "Merchants Chosen", a group of five merchants and family heads who support many of the city's businesses, own local land, or were instrumental in setting up the rebellion that freed the city from Amn's influence. The Count of Valashar is Lord Holver Roaringhorn, and is also, technically, the final word in the defense and ruling of Riatavin. However Lord Roaringhorn has left much of the running of Riatavin to the "Merchants Chosen", hoping that it will ease the transition of Riatavin becoming a new city of Tethyr.

A number of Tethyrian forces, as well as mercenaries have been present in Riatavin for the last six months preparing for the attack and siege by forces of Amn, who plan to bring Riatavin back into the fold. However, due to the large attacks, and slaughter of Amnian forces by hordes of evil creatures, led by giants, and followers of Cyric, Riatavin has been able to build up a large army for the defense of the city. Still, many believe that more work still needs to be done in the defense of the city. The evil army known as the Sythillisian Empire has been ravaging Amn, and keeping them busy, but many believe that they will soon turn their attention to Riatavin.

The forces of Riatavin are composed of the following:

The Ring Knights of Riatavin: 3,000 mounted troops

Tethyrian Soldiers: 3,000 foot soldiers

Mercenaries: 1,000 assorted soldiers

Adventurers: 150 assorted individuals with special skills

Wizards: 5 wizards(1envoker, 1diviner, 3 generalist)

Priests:

Waukeen- High priest Overgold Haeclar Dominit, Neutral hm P19

High Silver Dremen Coincounter, Neutral hm P11

(2) priests 6th level

(1) priest 5th level

(13) priests 1st thru 3rd level

(22) lay followers and initiates

Sune- High Priestess Heartwarder Qima Regirr, CG hf P13

Lovemistress Treana Asherton , CG hef P9

(1) priest of 7th level

(2) priestess of 5th level

(3) priestess of 3rd level

(9) lay followers or initiates

Approximately 7 shrines dedicated to the following deities- Azuth, Tymora, Gond, Torm, Tempus, Lurue, and Chauntea.

Notable NPC's that the characters may meet:

- 1) Lord Holver Roaringhorn, Count of Valashar
- 2) Lord Zelfhar Thann, Count of Rivershire, Siege lord of Tethyr
- 3) Archenal The Mighty, Ruler of "Mage Home"
- 4) Schripen, Sage of Riatavin
- 5) Jared SharpAxe, Captain of the Watch, Riatavin
- 6) Lord Horus Steelhelm, Mercenary General
- 7) Aerialya, Priestess of **Lurue**, P9
- 8) Jonathan Stell, Caravan Master
- 9) Bharavan Bhaerkantos, owner of the Thousandheads Trading Coster

Villians:

- 1) Dragar of the Black, Warrior of "The Nine", hm F6. He leads 36 1st thru 2nd level warriors.
- 2) Horthraxis, Young Black Dragon
- 3) Goblin tribe of the "Bloody Horn". 80 to 110 1HD goblins led by Egen, a 3HD goblin Chief
- 4) Treflar of **Malar**, hm P6, who leads 3 lycanthropes(wereboars)
- 5) Tregen, Murderer, Thief, Bandit Lord, hm F6, who leads 22 bandits 1st thru 2nd level warriors.
- 6) Xerxes, initiate of "The Nine", W6
- 7) Members of the Shadow Thieves, but only while in Riatavin.
- 8) Iltharis, Priestess of **Beshaba**
- 9) "The Nine", a covert cabal of unknown origin, who's members identities are also unknown

Adventure Synopsis

The group of local adventures is enlisted in the defense of Riatavin, and are sent to get help from the Mage known as Archenal The Mighty. Archenal has rebuilt an ancient school of wizardry located at the southern end of the Snowflake Mountains, in between the Soaring Spirit and Orgoths tower. Archenal is a hem W11/P12 of **Azuth**. Archenal will help the city of Riatavin with magical defense, if the group of adventures can retrieve an item know as The Brand of Azuth. The Brand is a silver enlaid torch that glows with a luminous white fire. It is said that while a spellcaster holds the Brand all spells are tripled in effect, duration, and damage. Legend say's that the Brand was to be a gift to **Mystra**, but was some how lost over the age's. Archenal believes the Brand rests in the ruins of an ancient temple located at the southernmost tip of the Snowflake Mountains. Archenal say's that there is some magic that prevents powerful spellcasters from entering the ruins. If they can retrieve the Brand and bring it back to him, he will lend his full magical might into the defense of Riatavin.

Hopefully the group accepts Archenals deal, and travels back to Riatavin to get supplies and inform the council of Archenals proposal. After leaving the city, the group should run into a caravan that has been recently attacked by Tregen and his bandits. The group can help the survivors and meet Jonathan Stell, the caravan master, and a employee of the Thousandheads Trading Coster. Jonathan will beg for the adventures help, promising them great wealth if they will hunt down the bandits and bring them to justice. Although the group may not agree totally, the directions the bandits were going happens to be the same directions as the ruins. Whatever the group decides to do, they should eventually continue on to the ruins. There should be limited random ecounters, so as not to weaken the group too much before they enter the ruins.

When the group arrives at the ruins, they find that the ruins are not unoccupied, and in fact overflowing with evil creatures. The size of the ruins, and the complexities of the creatures defenses are up to the individual DM's, however they should not be made too difficult if the group is of low or medium levels. During the course of the adventure, the group will find out that this group of evil creatures are servants of some evil cabal known as "The Nine". They won't find out much about "The Nine", except that there purposes are death, enslavement, and destruction for all. Xerxes is the representative of "The Nine", but is not a member. He is an initiate who hopes one day to be one of "The Nine". All the leaders of the combined evil groups have magical tatoo's emblazoned upon their chests. Each one is identical, and appears as nine pentagrams in a circle surrounded by a circle of magical runes, with a claw aflame in the center. Only the leaders have these tatoo's, and each tatoo gives the bearer a special power. Each power should be different for each individual, but should not be so powerful as to upset game balance.

The group will eventually find out that the Brand of Azuth is located in the hoard of Horthraxis. His hoard is growing fast for such a young dragon, but with the help of the bandits and goblins, he hopes to triple it's size within the next few months. Xerxes has made a pact with the dragon on behalf of "The Nine". They have promised him all the wealth he can imagine, and a "New" body, if only he will rise when they command, and do their bidding. Being the young, and greedy dragon that he is, he has agreed to their terms.

DM'S HINTS

Whatever the group decides to do, whether it is to sneak in and try to get the Brand, to fight their way in, or to go back to Riatavin for reinforcements and help, the adventure should be modified to fit the occasion. Gamemasters should not overload the adventures with lot's of magic items in the begining, but should instead make them earn them during the course of the adventure. DM's should make sure that all the characters start with a couple of healing potions apiece, and that they are fully healed and trained when the adventure begins. The recommended levels for play are 2nd thru 4th. They are several TSR products which are reccomended for play, but a must to have is the Box set entitled "Lands of Intrigue". Any questions, feedback, or advice is welcomed and appreciated.

Eric K. Rodriguez

Sequel

RIATAVINS INDEPENDENCE

A Forgotten Realms Adventure set in the Lands of Intrigue, Year DR1370, Month of Uktar. Exact location of adventure takes place in the city of Riatavin, a city that has just recently become a new member of Tethyr, and a part of the Golden Marches in the county of Valashar.

Riatavin is ruled by the "Merchants Chosen", a group of five merchants and family heads who support many of the city's businesses, own local land, or were instrumental in setting up the rebellion that freed the city from Amn's influence. The Count of Valashar is Lord Holver Roaringhorn, and is also, technically, the final word in the defense and ruling of Riatavin. However Lord Roaringhorn has left much of the running of Riatavin to the "Merchants Chosen", hoping that it will ease the transition of Riatavin becoming a new city of Tethyr.

A number of Tethyrian forces, as well as mercenaries have been present in Riatavin for the last six months preparing for the attack and siege by forces of Amn, who plan to bring Riatavin back into the fold. However, due to the large attacks, and slaughter of Amnian forces by hordes of evil creatures, led by giants, and followers of Cyric, Riatavin has been able to build up a large army for the defense of the city. Still, many believe that more work still needs to be done in the defense of the city. The evil army known as the Sythillisian Empire has been ravaging Amn, and keeping them busy, but many believe that they will soon turn their attention to Riatavin.

The forces of Riatavin are composed of the following:

The Ring Knights of Riatavin: 3,000 mounted troops
Tethyrian Soldiers: 3,000 foot soldiers
Mercenaries: 1,000 assorted soldiers
Adventurers: 150 assorted individuals with special skills
Wizards: 5 wizards
Priests:

Waukeen- High priest Overgold Haeclar Dominit, Neutral hm
High Silver Dremen Coincounter, Neutral hm
(38) priest & priestess of varying powers

Sune- High Priestess Heartwarder Qima Regirr, CG hf
Lovemistress Treana Asherton , CG hef
(15) priest & priestess of varying powers

Approximately 7 shrines dedicated to the following deities- Azuth, Tymora, Gond, Torm, Tempus, Lurue, and Chauntea.

Notable NPC's that the characters may meet:

- 1) Lord Holver Roaringhorn, Count of Valashar
- 2) Lord Zelphar Thann, Count of Rivershire, Siege lord of Tethyr
- 3) Archenal The Mighty, Ruler of "Mage Home"
- 4) Schripen, Sage of Riatavin
- 5) Jared SharpAxe, Captain of the Watch, Riatavin
- 6) Lord Horus Steelhelm, Mercenary General
- 7) Aerialya, Priestess of Lurue,
- 8) Jonathan Stell, Caravan Master
- 9) Bharavan Bhaerkantos, owner of the Thousandheads Trading Coster

Current Happenings:

Two months have passed since the city of Riatavin has declared it's independence. The city has been anxiously awaiting an attack by the Sythillisian Empire, hoping to draw their enemies forces out onto the plains for a decisive battle. However, it seems that the Sythillisian Empire has diverted it's attacks more to the north and west. Heralds from various city-states including a royal herald from Cormyr have arrived in Riatavin hoping to seek help from the lands of Tethyr. Lord Roaringhorn has spoken with the king and queen of Tethyr and has agreed to do what he can to help the southern cities of the Moonsea lands. Lord Roaringhorn has sent out a notice to all experienced adventures and mercenaries, that brave hero's are needed to stem the tide of evil. Renown and fame are yours to be had. By oder of his majesties of the land of Tethyr, any who aid in the destruction of the Sythillisian Empire will gain lands and title according to his or her's contribution. A reward fee has been placed on the head of every humanoid creature that serves the Sythillisian Empire. If you have the courage to help those in need, contact Captain of the Watch "Jared SharpAxe" at the East Gate Barracks.